pfi

Python for Fixed Income

COURSE 1 · PYTHON FOUNDATIONS

Case Study: A First Look at the Data

WEEK 2 · DAY 4

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This course is educational content created in a personal capacity. Nothing here is investment advice or a recommendation to buy or sell any security. All portfolio data is synthetic.

Three files, and nobody has checked they fit

Three systems, three files

The trading system	→ `positions.csv`
The reference data system	→ `issuers.csv`
A third system	→ `ratings.csv`

Built by different teams at different times. Nobody has checked that they fit together.

Your job, before any report is built

Know

each table: what one row is, how large it is, what each column holds

Check

each table for missing values and repeated rows

Test

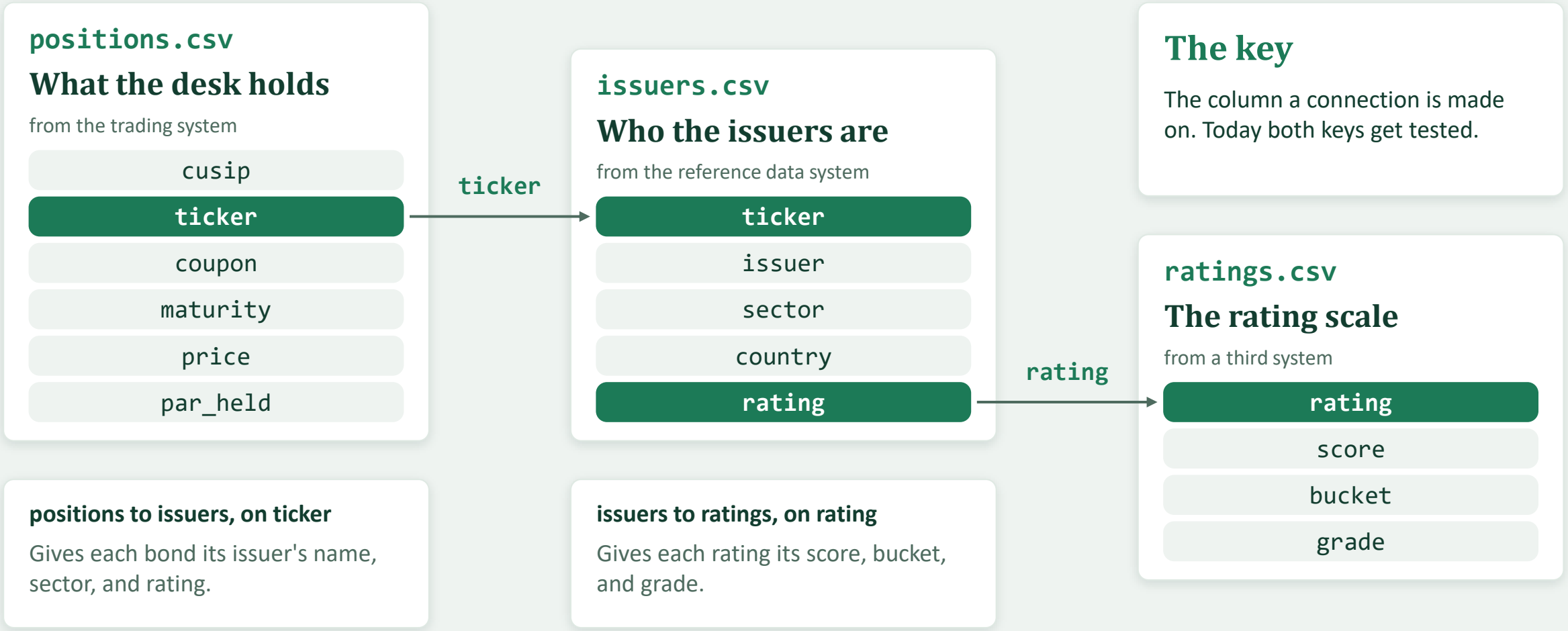
that the key columns will connect the tables cleanly

Report

what you found, and whether the tables are ready to join

Nothing is joined today. The join is tomorrow's work.

Three tables and the keys that link them



The same routine for every table

1
First rows
What does one row stand for?
`head()`
`tail()`

→

2
Shape
How many rows and columns?
`shape`

→

3
Data types
What does each column hold?
`dtypes`
`info()`

→

4
Summary
What do the values look like?
`describe()`

→

5
Missing and duplicates
Any gaps or repeated rows?
`isna()`
`duplicated()`

→

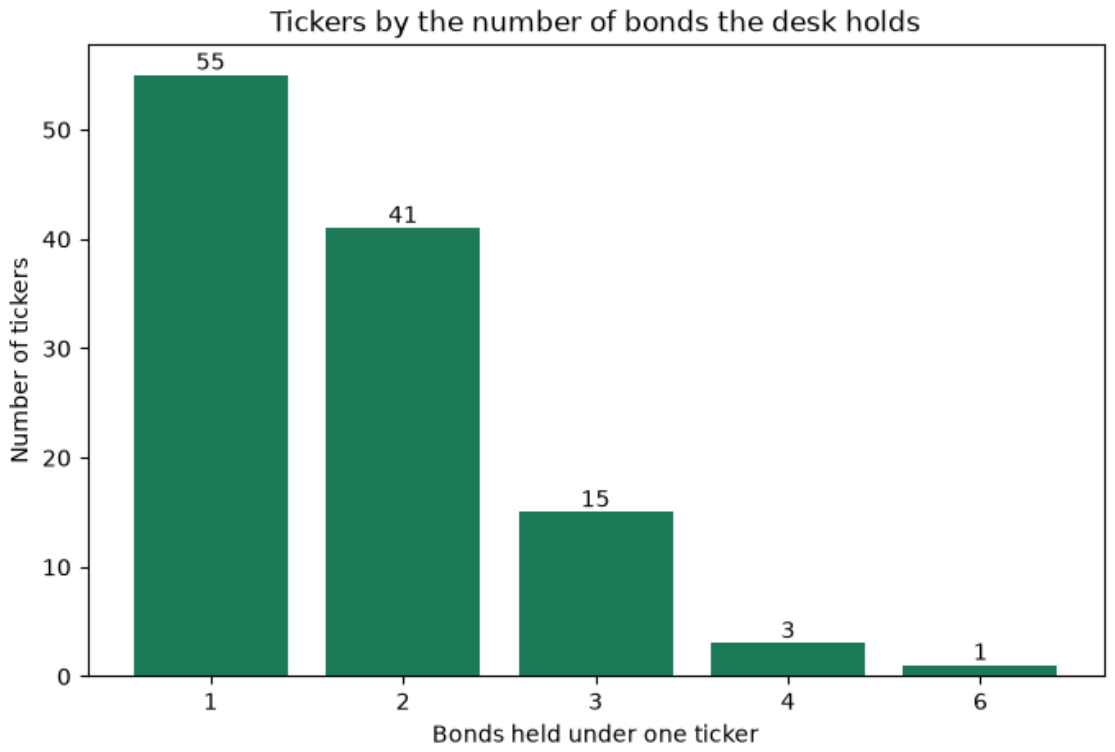
6
The key
Which column connects the tables?
`nunique()`
`is_unique`

Six Predict questions

Each shows code and asks what it will do.

Pause the video → **Decide** → **Then run the cell**

Tickers and flags



The ticker is not a key

55 tickers have one bond, 41 have two, one has six

Flags are columns of True

flags.sum() counts down a column: 113, 34, 29

Across a row

flags.sum(axis=1): 61 bonds carry none, 7 carry all three

Week 3 teaches charts. For now, read the picture and check it against the notebook.

Positions: one row is one bond held

200
rows, one bond held each

6
columns: 3 numbers, 3 text

0
missing values or duplicates

489,000,000
of face held in total

```
positions[['cusip', 'ticker',
'maturity']].describe()

            cusip ticker    maturity
count         200    200         200
unique        200    115         196
top     99080CAE8   NEVX  2031-03-03
freq            1      6           2
```

The CUSIP is distinct on every row. The ticker is not: 115 tickers cover the 200 bonds.

The maturity arrived as text

`pd.to_datetime(positions['maturity'])`

All 200 convert: 2027-10-02 to 2056-08-23.

The same checks in Excel

`=COUNTBLANK(E2:E201)`	missing values in a column
Remove Duplicates	counts repeats and deletes them

Issuers: one row is one issuer

```
issuers['sector'].value_counts()
```

sector	issuers
Materials	18
Utilities	18
Energy	17
Industrials	17
Telecom	16
Transportation	15
Consumer	14
Financials	14
Health Care	12
Technology	9

150
issuers, one row each

5
columns, all of them text

0
missing values or duplicate rows

18
distinct ratings, and 1 country

```
issuers['rating'].mean()

TypeError: Cannot perform reduction 'mean' with string dtype
```

Why it failed

A rating is letters. BBB- and A+ cannot be added or averaged.

→

Where the number is

The score of each rating is in ratings.csv. That is why the tables must be joined.

The rating scale: one row is one rating

ratings.csv: 18 rows and 4 columns, small enough to read in full

Investment Grade: 10 ratings, scores 1 to 10										High Yield: 8 ratings, scores 11 to 18							
AAA	AA+	AA	AA-	A+	A	A-	BBB+	BBB	BBB-	BB+	BB	BB-	B+	B	B-	CCC+	CCC
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
AAA	AA			A			BBB			BB			B			CCC	

Top to bottom: grade, rating, score, bucket

1 to 18

Every score once, in order, with no gap

7 and 2

Seven buckets and two grades, one grade per rating

0

Missing values or duplicate rows

score

The only number in the table, and the one mean() needed

Is each key unique?

positions: many rows

cusip	ticker	coupon
99054CAF7	NEVX	4.625
99054CAB6	NEVX	6.250
99054CAC4	NEVX	6.250
99054CAD2	NEVX	6.125
99054CAG5	NEVX	3.875
99054CAH3	NEVX	5.250

issuers: one row

ticker	issuer	rating
NEVX	Nevulex Health	BBB-

Six NEVX bonds point to one issuer row.

```
print('ticker in issuers:', issuers['ticker'].is_unique)
print('rating in ratings:', ratings['rating'].is_unique)

ticker in issuers: True
rating in ratings: True
```

From a column that repeats to one that is unique

Table	Column	Unique?	Role
positions	`cusip`	yes	identifies one bond
positions	`ticker`	no	points to an issuer
issuers	`ticker`	yes	identifies one issuer
issuers	`rating`	no	points to a rating
ratings	`rating`	yes	identifies one rating

The same test in Excel

`=COUNTIF(A:A, A2)`

A helper column, filtered for values above 1

Remove Duplicates

On a copy: if it removes nothing, the key is unique

Every key has a match

Is every ticker of the positions in the issuers table?

The issuers table: 150 issuers

115

held by the desk. All 200 positions find their issuer here.

35

not held

```
found = positions['ticker'].isin(
    issuers['ticker'])
print(found.all())
True
```

Written down today, checked tomorrow

200

rows, after each join

13

columns at the end

489,000,000

of face, unchanged

Join	Key	Expected result
positions to issuers	`ticker`	200 rows, 10 columns
that result to ratings	`rating`	200 rows, 13 columns

```
=NOT(ISNA(MATCH(B2, issuers!A:A, 0)))
```

In Excel: filled down, TRUE where the ticker is found.

Checks that stop the notebook

`assert condition, 'message'` Silent when the condition is True. When it is False, the notebook stops with the message.

assert this condition	or stop with this message
`positions.isna().sum().sum() == 0`	the positions have missing values
`positions.duplicated().sum() == 0`	the positions have repeated rows
`issuers['ticker'].is_unique`	a ticker appears twice in the issuers table
`ratings['rating'].is_unique`	a rating appears twice in the rating scale
`positions['ticker'].isin(issuers['ticker']).all()`	a position has a ticker that is not in the issuers table
`issuers['rating'].isin(ratings['rating']).all()`	an issuer has a rating that is not on the scale

```
# this condition is False: 115 tickers cover 200 rows
assert positions['ticker'].is_unique, 'the ticker repeats in the positions, so it cannot identify a bond'
AssertionError: the ticker repeats in the positions, so it cannot identify a bond
```

`=IF(COUNTIF(G2:G201, FALSE)=0, "OK", "CHECK")` In Excel, a check cell shows the result, and every other formula goes on calculating. An assert stops the run.

The AI check

Every notebook ends with code written in the style of an AI assistant. It has one bug. Find it.

1

Read

Read the code before you run it.

2

Predict

Decide what it should produce.

3

Run

Run it and look at the output.

4

Check

Compare with a number you worked out yourself.

Code that runs is not the same as code that is right.

What you can do now

- Give any new table the same first look: rows, shape, types, summary
- Count missing values and repeated rows before they distort a total
- Test each key with is_unique and isin()
- Count yes or no flags down a column and across a row
- Write the tests as assert statements, and write down what a join should return

Tomorrow Case study, part two: joining the three tables and answering the desk's questions